

Kaizen in the Bible — Sanctification

(Notes — 2-25-26)

Sanctification is incremental growth where we genuinely work because God genuinely works in us.

Key Term

Sanctification (Greek: *hagiasmos*)

Sanctification describes the **lifelong, ongoing process of being transformed** into Christlikeness.

1. Transformation of the Mind

Romans 12:2

“Be transformed by the renewing of your mind.”

Spiritual growth involves:

- Renewal of thinking
 - Reorientation of desires
 - Progressive conformity to Christ
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2. Strengthening and Perseverance

Hebrew Concept: *Chazaq*

Meaning:

- To strengthen
- To be firm (resolved)

It carries the idea of:

- Pressing forward
 - Growing stronger
 - Intentional development
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3. Wisdom Grows Gradually

The book of **Proverbs** emphasizes wisdom that is **accumulated gradually through discipline**.

“The path of the righteous is like the morning sun, shining ever brighter till the full light of day.” Proverbs 4:18

Growth in godliness:

- Begins small
- Develops progressively
- Becomes clearer and stronger over time

4. The Parable of the Talents and Faithful Stewardship

- The **Parable of the Talents** has a “**Kaizen**” dimension.
- The **praised servants** were the ones who **took what they were given and incrementally built on it**.
- **Stagnation was condemned.**

Principle:

God commends faithful **growth and development**, not passivity.

5. Biblical Transformation: Relational and Grace-Dependent

Biblical transformation is:

- Relational
- Grace-dependent

You grow **with** God's help.

Transformation is not self-generated improvement; it occurs **in relationship with God through His grace**.

6. The Spirit's Work Within the Believer for Change

With God's help:

- The **Spirit actively works inside a person**.
- He **shapes desires**.
- He **corrects wrong patterns**.
- He **produces character traits**.

These traits are the **Fruit of the Spirit** (Galatians 5).

Key insight:

The **change is coming from within**, but the **source of that inner working is God**.

7. Divine-Human Cooperation

Philippians 2:12–13

“Work out your own salvation with fear and trembling, for it is God who works in you both to will and to act.”

This passage captures the cooperation well:

- We are *genuinely* trying
- God is *genuinely* enabling the trying

Sanctification is therefore **active obedience empowered by divine grace**.

Summary Principle

Biblical Sanctification resembles a spiritual form of “Kaizen.”

It involves:

- Incremental growth
- Spirit-empowered change
- Intentional cooperation with God
- Progressive transformation of character

We **work**, but **God works within us**.

Whiteboard Teaching Layout

Final Board Statement

Biblical Sanctification = Spiritual Kaizen

- Incremental growth
- Spirit-empowered change
- Faithful obedience
- Lifelong transformation

We work — because God works within us.



Sanctification as Spiritual Kaizen

How to Explain It (30-Second Teaching)

Top:

God is the **ultimate source of change**.

“God works in you to will and to act.” (Phil 2:13)

Left:

We are called to **actively pursue obedience**.

“Work out your salvation.” (Phil 2:12)

Bottom:

The way this normally happens is **incrementally**.

Small acts of obedience.

Small growth.

Small repentance.

Small steps.

Result:

Over time this becomes **sanctification**.

The Key Insight (Write This Next to the Diagram)

Sanctification happens when God's power meets daily obedience.

or

God supplies the power.

We supply the obedience.

Growth happens incrementally.